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ANNOUNCEMENT OF GIFT

The Board of Regents of the University of Texas, Austin, Texas, announced their acceptance of a Deed of Trust made by Frederic Allen Williams, conveying to the University his entire collection of sculpture and supporting anthropological material and craft work. The University of Texas, in accepting this gift, agrees to set aside space in its new Academic Center which will soon be constructed, and through its Arts and Sciences Foundation has arranged to care for the Frederic Allen Williams collection in perpetuity. The right of possession and the enjoyment of the entire collection remains in Mr. Williams' hands during his lifetime.

The unique feature of the Frederic Allen Williams Collection is that it presents a complete story of the growth of the artist and indicates the diversity of interests which marks his development. This personal motif of the growth of the sculptor is augmented by a rich horde of historical material, by means of which, through research and adaptation, he is able to use such material to his creative purpose.

In Group One of the Collection is to be found portrait heads of prominent persons of the early days of aviation. These adventurers in a new science are all know to Mr. Williams, and their heads were modeled from life. Also in this group are a number of portraits of poets, writers, musicians and jurists--all friends of Mr. Williams and his family.

In Group Two there is to be found the Indian sculpture, which reflects the deep interest and many journeys which Frederic Allen Williams has made to the western part of the United States. Among his own sculpture is to be interspersed Mr. Williams's collection of Indian textiles, baskets, pottery and artifacts, thus bringing into sharp focus the relationship that anthropological knowledge and research has had on the sculptor's own work. His Indian sculpture, characteristic for its grace of movement and variation in color, reaches its zenith in a high-relief "Madonna of the Pueblos" and two colossal figures of Indian high priests. When it is installed at the University of Texas, this Indian group will have as its focal point a work on which Mr. Williams has spent 12 years of research and labor, known as the "Shrine of the Americas." This, in traditional altar form, with retable and reredos, candlesticks and flower receptacles, all utilizing Indian lore and design, is interepreted in terms of Christian theology. A Madonna holding high a child is surrounded by a representation of the Trinity in Indian form. Ten figures representing the high priests or chiefs of various American Indian localities stand below the Madonna on the retable of the altar. The sculptured frontal and side panels of the altar, itself, bear decorative relief models of animals and vegetation associated with the Indians of all the Americas.

The Third Group of Mr. Williams's collection contains the fruit of more than 40 years of astute acquisition and is known as The Horse Museum. This collection, now comprising several thousand items in which the horse appears as the chief decorative motif, is regarded by Mr. Williams as being only the nucleus of a collection that will tell of the saga of the horse. It is capable of expansion and it was because of the agreement of the University of Texas to keep this collection as a growing one that Mr. Williams decided on the present Deed of Trust. The Horse Museum presents the story of the horse in its relationship to man--in many lands and in all periods of history--until its culmination in the Western United States of America, where the horse played its leading and final role as a principal factor in the process of civilization.

Also included in the gift to the University are books, photographs, lantern slides and other written and pictorial reference materials related to and supporting the various sections of Mr. Williams's vast collection.

Frederic Allen Williams was born in West Newton, Mass., April 10, 1898, the son of Dr. Frederic Allen and Elizabeth Paine Williams. Dr. Williams was an ophthamologist and lawyer of Boston, and for many years practiced in an official capacity in both professions in the city of New York. His material ancestors, originating in New England, settled in Minnesota. Captain James Martin Paine, an Indian fighter, and Ellen Adele Elkins Paine were his grandfather and grandmother. Through this branch of his family, Frederic Allen Williams, the sculptor, is descended from the Rev. William Paine, a chaplain in General George Washington's army at Valley Forge, and was distantly related to Thomas Paine, American revolutionary writer and political theorist.

U.T. BOARD OF REGENTS, ANNOUNCEMENT OF GIFT, FREDERIC WILLIAMS COLLECTION

Frederic Allen Williams was educated in the Boston Latin A School, Columbia University, the Beaux Arts Institute of Design and the National Academy of Design. His works of art have appeared in practically all the leading sculpture exhibitions in the United States during the last 40 years. Mr. Williams was past president and member of the American Veterans Society of Artists, Inc., vice president of American Rough Riders, Inc., member of the New York Ceramic Socity, American Artists Professional League, Artist Guild, Rodeo Cowboys Association, Ends of the Earth, Trail Riders of the Canadian Rockies, Minnesota Historical Society, and Florida Society in the East. Mr. Williams is author of articles: AMERICA'S GREATEST INVENTION (Horse), DEEP IN THE HEART OF TEXAS, PENDLETON ROUNDUP, CALGARY STAMPEDE, and others. His studio is at 58 West 57th Street, New York City.